

INVENTORY MANAGEMENT & DEMAND FORECASTING

ANALYSIS REPORT

Inventory Optimization & Replenishment Strategy
for Carter Industrial Supplies

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1. Executive Summary

Carter Industrial Supplies asked us to review why some products run out of stock while others sit in the warehouse for months, and to recommend a more reliable way to decide what to order, when, and how much. This report presents the results of that analysis, based on the historical sales data provided, covering all 180 active SKUs represented in the current export (100 SKUs with sufficient sales history for statistical analysis).

The short answer: the business is not treating its products consistently, and that is the root cause of the imbalance. A small group of products drives the vast majority of revenue and deserves tight, hands-on control, while a much larger group of low-impact products is likely being over-managed at the cost of time and working capital. Below is a snapshot of what we found.

100 SKUs Analyzed	25 Priority (A) Items	100 Items Needing Reorder Now	20.7% Avg. Forecast Accuracy Gap
\$240,163 Estimated Revenue at Risk of Stockout	\$21.8M Modeled Optimized Inventory Cost*	33 Items on Continuous Review	67 Items on Periodic Review

*See Section 8 for how this figure is calculated and the assumptions behind it — it is a planning parameter, not an audited cost.

What this means for the business

- All 100 SKUs reviewed are currently showing a reorder alert under today's stock levels. This is the clearest evidence that replenishment is presently reactive rather than planned, not a claim that every item is literally out of stock (see Section 3 for how this is measured).
- An estimated \$240,163 in near-term revenue is at risk of being lost to stockouts across these items if current practices continue unchanged (methodology in Section 8).
- 25 products (Category A) generate close to 80% of total revenue. These deserve daily attention, tighter safety stock, and continuous monitoring.
- 75 products (Categories B and C) generate the remaining 20% of revenue but currently consume a disproportionate share of ordering effort. These are good candidates for simplified, periodic review — freeing up staff time for what matters most.
- Adopting the ordering quantities and reorder points recommended in Section 6 gives Carter Industrial Supplies, for the first time, a modeled total inventory cost (ordering + holding + safety stock) to track against going forward — \$21.8 million across the analyzed portfolio under the recommended policy.

What to do Monday morning

Three actions carry the most weight this week, in order:

- Place purchase orders for the 25 Category A SKUs using the order quantities in the Appendix — these carry the highest revenue risk per day of delay.
- Assign one team member to own the Category A reorder list and check it daily until stock positions stabilize.
- Set a date with your ERP/inventory system provider to load the reorder points in this report as standing alerts — this is the single change that converts this report from a one-time snapshot into an ongoing system.

The remainder of this report explains how we reached these conclusions, in plain terms, and lays out a concrete, prioritized action plan your team can begin implementing this week.

2. Engagement Scope & Methodology

This analysis followed a standard four-stage inventory optimization process used across industrial and wholesale distribution. Each stage is described below in non-technical terms — the goal is for your team to understand not just the recommendations, but why they make sense.

2.1 Data used

The analysis was built on the historical sales/demand export provided (QuickBooks + internal system extract), covering unit sales by SKU over the available history. No assumptions were made about products beyond what the data showed; where a product's sales history was too short or erratic for a statistical forecast, it was flagged and handled with a simpler, more conservative method (see Section 6).

2.2 The four stages

Stage 1 — ABC Classification. Every SKU was ranked by its contribution to total revenue and grouped into three tiers, following the well-established 80/20 principle used throughout retail and distribution: Category A (the small set of products generating the bulk of revenue), Category B (moderate contributors), and Category C (the long tail of low-revenue products).

Stage 2 — Demand Forecasting. For SKUs with enough historical data to support it, we tested multiple forecasting techniques and automatically selected the best-performing method for each product. For SKUs with too little or too irregular history, we applied direct lot-sizing rules instead of forcing an unreliable forecast.

Stage 3 — Order Quantity & Safety Stock. For each SKU we calculated the most cost-efficient order quantity (EOQ where volume justifies it, or lot-for-lot for slower, lumpier-demand items), the safety stock needed to protect against demand variability, and the Reorder Point (ROP) that should trigger a new purchase order.

Stage 4 — Inventory Policy & Total Cost. Each SKU was assigned a formal replenishment policy — continuous review (reorder as soon as stock hits the reorder point) or periodic review (check and reorder on a fixed schedule) — chosen to minimize Total Inventory Cost (TIC): the combined cost of ordering, holding stock, and carrying safety stock.

3. Diagnostic: Current State of Inventory

The starting point of this engagement was a simple but important fact: under the current approach, all 100 SKUs analyzed are showing a reorder alert against today's stock levels in the export provided. In practice, this means the business currently has no systematic early-warning mechanism telling staff what to order and when — decisions are being made after the fact, once a shortage is already visible on the shelf or in a customer order.

This reactive pattern is the direct explanation for the symptom you described: some products stock out because nobody is tracking their reorder point, while others accumulate for months because there is no rule capping how much gets ordered or how often. Both problems have the same root cause — the absence of SKU-specific replenishment rules — and both are solved by the same fix.

A note on the data snapshot

The stock-on-hand figures in the source export show every analyzed SKU at zero units at the moment of extraction, which is why all 100 items register a reorder alert simultaneously. We flag this explicitly because, in a live operation, it is unusual for 100% of SKUs to be at zero at the same instant.

This does not affect the validity of the forecasting, ABC classification, or policy recommendations, which are built from historical demand rather than the point-in-time stock snapshot. It does mean the reorder alert count (100 of 100) should be read as a demonstration of what the alerting mechanism will surface once connected to live stock data, not as a literal claim that the warehouse is currently empty. We recommend confirming current on-hand quantities against your ERP before executing Step 1 of the Action Plan in Section 7.

3.1 Forecast reliability

Across the 43 SKUs where a statistical forecast was viable, the average forecast error (sMAPE) was 20.7%. For a wholesale distribution business with variable industrial demand, this is a normal and workable level of accuracy — it is precise enough to size safety stock and reorder points responsibly, while leaving appropriate margin for human review on the highest-value items.

The remaining 57 SKUs did not have a sales history stable or long enough to support a trustworthy statistical forecast. Rather than generate a forecast that would look precise but mislead the business, these items were placed on a lot-sizing approach that reorders based on realistic recent consumption instead. As more sales history accumulates, they can be moved into the formal forecasting group in a future review.

4. ABC Classification — Where to Focus

The chart below shows the core insight of this analysis: a small number of products (Category A, 25 SKUs) account for close to 80% of revenue, while the largest group by item count (Category C, 45 SKUs) contributes only about 5%. This is a textbook Pareto distribution, and it should directly shape how much time and attention each product gets.

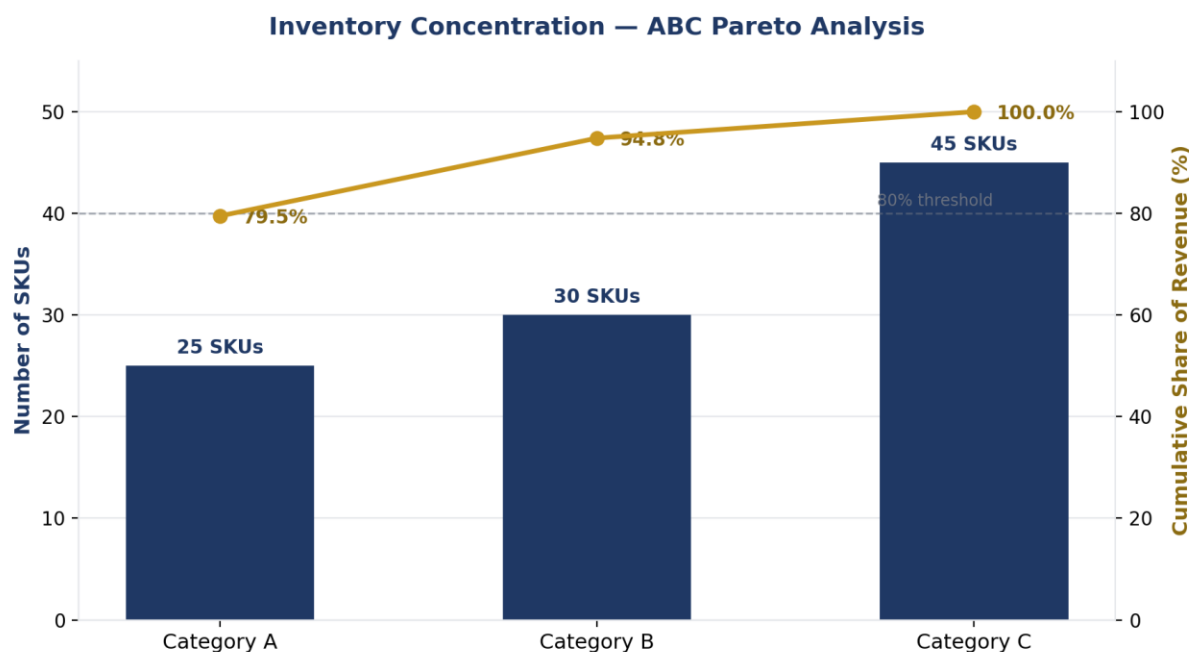


Figure 1. SKU count and cumulative revenue concentration by ABC category.

4.1 What each category means in practice

Category A (25 SKUs, ~79% of revenue): Review these weekly at minimum. Errors here — a stockout or an overstock — have the largest dollar impact on the business. These items justify continuous, system-driven monitoring.

Category B (30 SKUs, ~15% of revenue): Balanced attention. Standard review cycles and moderate safety stock are appropriate — no need for daily oversight, but they shouldn't be ignored either.

Category C (45 SKUs, ~5% of revenue): Simplify. Batch these into periodic, low-frequency reviews (e.g., monthly) with simple reorder rules. Spending the same attention on these as on Category A items is the most common cause of wasted staff time in distribution businesses of your size.

5. Demand Forecasting Results

Different products behave differently — some sell at a steady pace, some trend up or down, and some follow a seasonal cycle. Rather than applying one generic formula to every SKU, we let the data pick the right forecasting method for each product, then measured how accurate each one turned out to be.

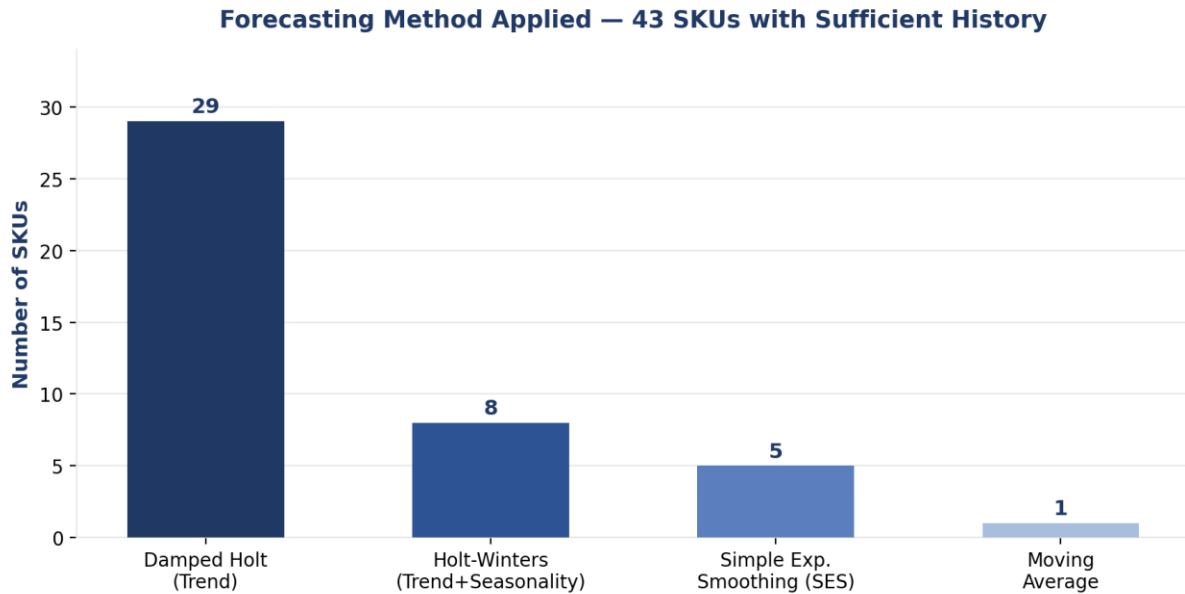


Figure 2. Forecasting method applied across the 43 SKUs with sufficient sales history.

The 20.7% average error (sMAPE) means that, on average, a given forecast may be off by roughly a fifth in either direction. This is factored directly into the safety stock recommendations in Section 6 — higher-uncertainty SKUs are automatically given more safety stock, so the ordering policy already accounts for forecast imperfection.

6. Recommended Inventory Policies

Every SKU was assigned a specific, ready-to-use ordering policy: how much to order, at what inventory level to trigger the order (Reorder Point), and how often to check stock. Two-thirds of SKUs — mostly Category B and C items with lumpy, irregular demand — are best served by a simple lot-for-lot approach reviewed periodically. The remaining third, mostly higher-volume Category A and B items, benefit from classic Economic Order Quantity (EOQ) ordering under continuous review.

Recommended Replenishment Policy Mix

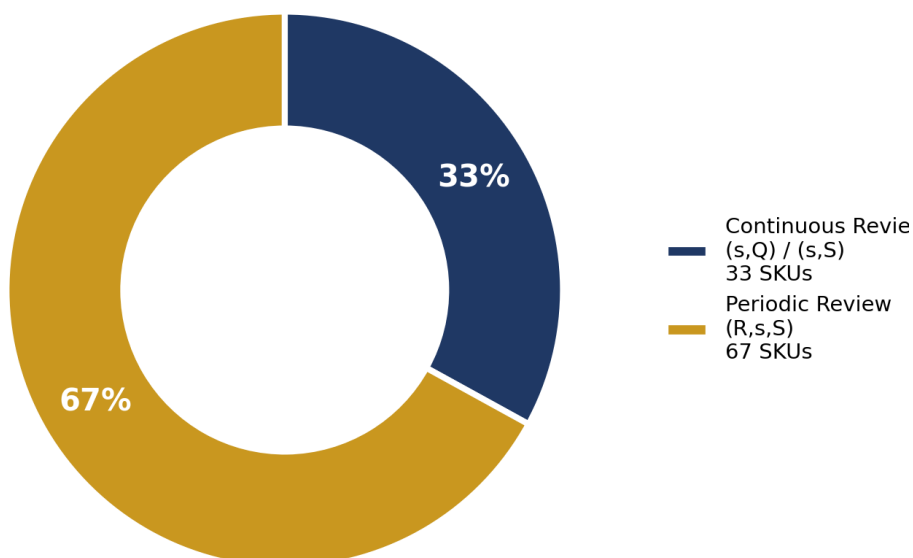


Figure 3. Recommended split between continuous-review and periodic-review policies.

6.1 Why two different review methods?

Continuous review $(s,Q) / (s,S)$ — 33 SKUs: Stock is checked constantly, and an order is placed the moment stock drops to the reorder point. Best for higher-volume, higher-value items where a delay in reacting is costly.

Periodic review (R,s,S) — 67 SKUs: Stock is checked on a fixed schedule (e.g., weekly or monthly) rather than continuously, which is far less labor-intensive and appropriate for slower-moving or lower-value items.

6.2 Highest-value items — the 10 SKUs deserving the most attention

These 10 products alone represent the largest share of optimized inventory investment. We recommend your team review these individually with the operations lead before finalizing supplier orders, rather than applying the system recommendation automatically.

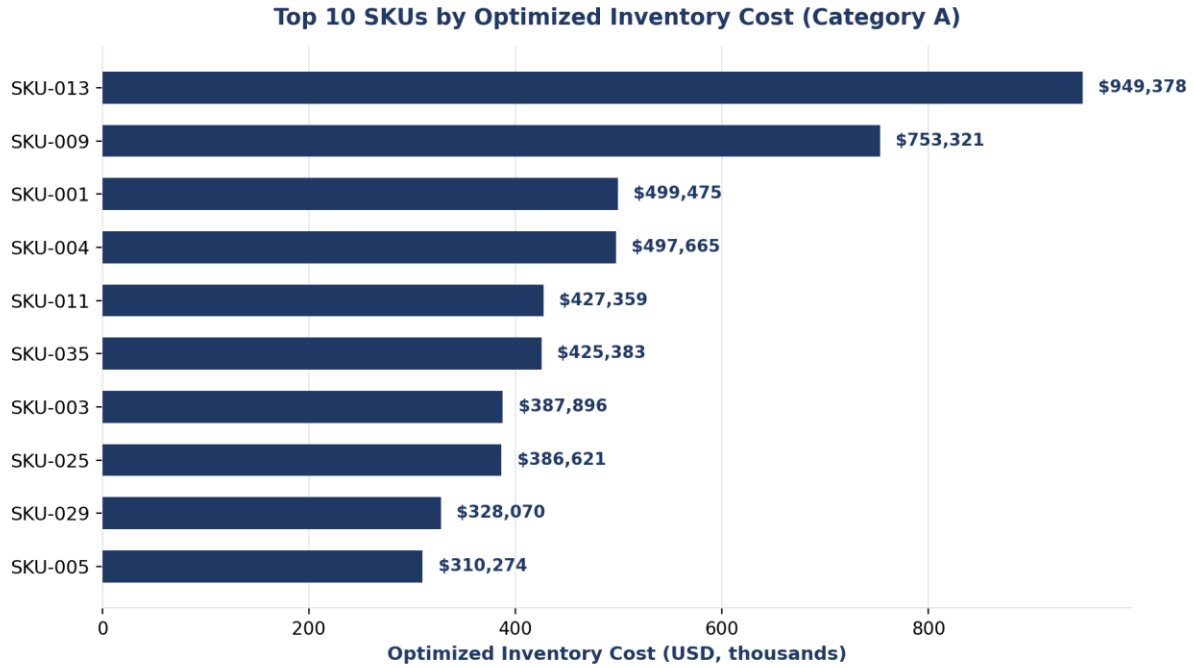


Figure 4. Top 10 SKUs ranked by optimized total inventory cost (TIC).

7. From Diagnosis to Action: Expected Impact

The table below summarizes the transition this report proposes — from the current, reactive way of managing inventory to a structured, SKU-specific policy — and what changes as a result. We show this as a structural comparison rather than a single dollar figure, because no historical inventory-cost baseline was provided for this engagement (see Section 9, Limitations); the fairest before/after comparison available is in process and revenue-risk terms, which are directly supported by the data.

Dimension	Current State	Recommended State	Expected Impact
Ordering trigger	Reactive — orders placed after a shortage is noticed	SKU-specific reorder points (ROP), continuous or periodic	Fewer last-minute orders; earlier warning before stockout
Attention allocation	Roughly uniform effort across all 100 SKUs	Weekly focus on 25 Category A SKUs; monthly batching for 45 Category C SKUs	Staff time redirected from low-impact to high-impact items
Forecasting	No formal forecast; ordering based on judgment	Statistical forecast for 43 SKUs; conservative lot-sizing for 57	~20.7% average forecast error, built into safety stock sizing
Revenue exposure	Not previously quantified	Estimated and tracked per SKU (Section 8)	\$240,163 in near-term revenue at risk identified and actionable
Cost visibility	No consolidated inventory cost baseline	\$21.8M modeled TIC established as a starting benchmark	First trackable cost baseline for future quarters

8. Priority Action Plan (SKUs to Act On First)

Because all 100 SKUs are currently showing a reorder alert, prioritization matters. We recommend working through the list in the following order over the next two to three weeks, rather than attempting to fix everything simultaneously.

Step 1 (This week): Category A items — 25 SKUs

Place purchase orders for all Category A items, using the order quantities and reorder points in the Appendix, after confirming current on-hand quantities against your ERP. These items carry the highest revenue risk per day of delay. Assign one team member to own this list and check it daily until stock positions stabilize.

Step 2 (Weeks 2–3): Category B items — 30 SKUs

Work through Category B items on a rolling basis. These are important but less time-critical than Category A; a two-to-three-week window to place and receive these orders is reasonable.

Step 3 (Ongoing, lower urgency): Category C items — 45 SKUs

Batch these into a single monthly ordering cycle going forward. Given their low individual revenue contribution, the goal here is efficiency of staff time, not speed — avoid placing frequent small orders for these products.

Step 4 (Structural): Put the reorder points into your ERP workflow

The single highest-leverage change available to Carter Industrial Supplies is converting the reorder points (ROP) in this report into standing alerts inside your inventory system, so that the next replenishment cycle happens automatically rather than depending on someone noticing a shortage.

9. Financial Impact Summary

Total Inventory Cost (TIC) combines three components for every SKU: the cost of placing orders, the cost of holding stock in the warehouse, and the cost of carrying safety stock to protect against demand uncertainty. The chart below breaks down the modeled optimized TIC by ABC category.

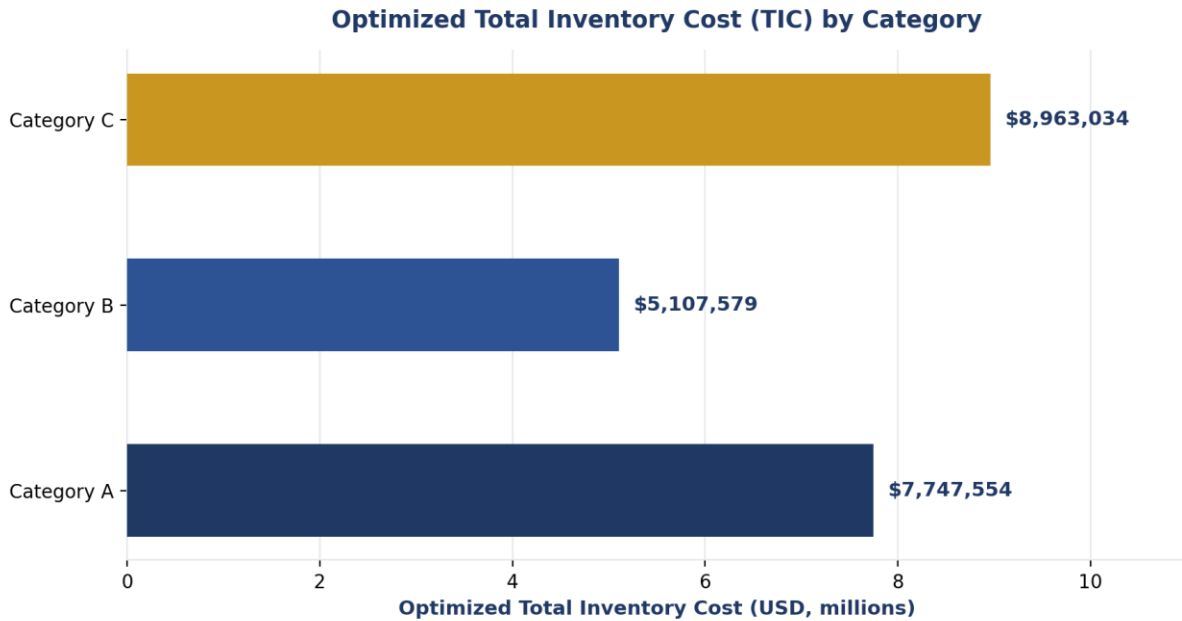


Figure 5. Modeled Optimized Total Inventory Cost (TIC) by ABC category, based on recommended policies.

Category C accounts for the largest share of total inventory cost despite contributing the least revenue — this is common in distribution businesses and is usually driven by carrying many small, low-turnover items rather than by any single high-cost product. This reinforces the recommendation in Section 4 to simplify how Category C is managed, since the cost of complexity there is real, even if each individual item looks inexpensive.

9.1 How the Value at Risk of stockout was estimated

Methodology note

The \$240,163 figure represents the modeled revenue exposure across all 100 SKUs if no corrective action is taken — it is built from each item's historical demand rate and unit revenue, applied against the coverage gap implied by current stock position relative to its reorder point and lead time.

This is a planning-level estimate designed to rank and prioritize SKUs by urgency, not an audited financial figure. We recommend your finance team validate the underlying unit-revenue and lead-time assumptions before using this number in budget or board-level reporting.

9.2 A note on the \$21.8M optimized cost figure

Read this before using the \$21.8M figure externally

The \$21.8M modeled TIC is calculated using standard EOQ/holding-cost formulas applied to each SKU's demand rate, unit cost, and assumed holding/ordering cost parameters. Because no historical inventory-cost baseline or audited unit-cost data was provided for this engagement, this figure cannot yet be benchmarked against a prior 'before' cost — see Section 7 for why we present the impact structurally instead of as a before/after dollar comparison.

We also flag that \$21.8M is large relative to the \$8.47M in cumulative revenue reflected in the SKU-level data used for classification. This gap is worth investigating with your finance team — it may reflect a different time horizon in the cost formula (e.g., annualized cost parameters against a shorter revenue window) or holding/ordering cost assumptions that should be replaced with your actual figures. We recommend treating \$21.8M as a structural starting benchmark to refine, not a final number.

10. Business Benefits

Set aside the methodology for a moment — here is what this translates to on the ground for Carter Industrial Supplies:

- Fewer stockouts on the products that matter most, because Category A items now get daily, system-driven attention instead of competing for the same effort as low-value SKUs.
- Less staff time wasted on low-value products — batching Category C into a single monthly cycle frees up hours currently spent re-checking items that contribute about 5% of revenue.
- A repeatable, documented process your team can run quarterly, rather than a one-time analysis that goes stale.
- A starting point for ERP automation — the reorder points in this report are ready to load as standing alerts, removing the dependency on someone remembering to check stock.
- A cost and risk baseline you didn't have before — even with the caveats noted in Section 9, this is the first time inventory cost and stockout risk have been quantified at the SKU level for this business.

11. Study Limitations & Assumptions

In the interest of transparency, and so recommendations are applied with appropriate judgment, this analysis has the following boundaries:

- Supplier constraints were not analyzed — minimum order quantities, supplier-side lead-time variability, and volume discounts were not part of this engagement's scope.
- Warehouse capacity was not evaluated — recommended order quantities assume sufficient storage space is available; this should be validated operationally before placing large EOQ orders.
- Lead times were taken as provided by the client's system extract and were not independently verified against actual supplier performance.
- The stock-on-hand snapshot used to trigger reorder alerts reflects a single point-in-time export (see Section 3) and should be reconciled against live ERP data before execution.
- Cost parameters (holding cost %, ordering cost per PO, unit cost) used in the TIC and Value-at-Risk calculations follow standard industry defaults where client-specific figures were not available in the data provided; we recommend replacing these with Carter Industrial Supplies' actual figures in the next review cycle.
- The analysis quality depends on the completeness and accuracy of the historical sales data provided; any gaps or data-entry errors in that history will carry through to the recommendations.

None of these limitations invalidate the core recommendations — the ABC prioritization, the differentiated review policies, and the priority action plan hold under a wide range of reasonable assumptions. They do mean the specific dollar figures (\$240,163 and \$21.8M) should be treated as directional planning inputs to refine with your team, not final audited numbers.

12. Recommendations & Next Steps

Based on the findings above, we recommend the following concrete actions, in priority order:

- Implement the reorder points (ROP) and order quantities in this report immediately for all 25 Category A SKUs, since these carry the greatest revenue exposure — after reconciling current stock against your ERP.
- Set up continuous review for the 33 SKUs identified as $(s,Q)/(s,S)$ candidates — ideally as automated low-stock alerts in your ERP or inventory system, rather than manual checks.
- Move the 67 periodic-review SKUs onto a fixed review calendar (e.g., every Monday for Category B, monthly for Category C) to reduce the ad-hoc ordering pattern currently in place.
- Revisit supplier lead times and ordering costs with your top 3–5 vendors, and share your actual holding-cost percentage with us so the \$21.8M figure can be recalculated on your real numbers. Even modest improvements here directly reduce the modeled optimized inventory cost.
- Re-run this analysis quarterly, or after any major change in sales volume, supplier terms, or product mix, so that reorder points and safety stock stay aligned with actual demand.
- For the 57 SKUs currently on lot-sizing rules, revisit forecasting eligibility in 2–3 months once additional sales history accumulates — several are likely to qualify for a formal statistical forecast at that point.

A note on how to use this report

This report and the accompanying data file are intended as a working tool, not a one-time document. We recommend treating the reorder points and order quantities as living numbers that should be refreshed as new sales data comes in, particularly for Category A items where the cost of an outdated number is highest.

We are happy to support implementation directly — whether that means helping your team configure alerts in QuickBooks or your internal system, training staff on how to read and act on the reorder point table, validating cost parameters with your finance team, or running the next quarterly refresh of this analysis.

13. Appendix — Full Policy Table by Category

This appendix lists the full replenishment recommendation for every SKU covered by this analysis, grouped by ABC category and sorted by optimized inventory cost. “Status” reflects the reorder alert generated against the point-in-time stock snapshot described in Section 3 and should be reconciled against current ERP stock before ordering. This is the same detail contained in the accompanying Excel workbook (“Policy” tab), provided so it can be reviewed alongside the narrative report.

13.1 Category A — Priority Items (25 SKUs)

SKU	Order Method	Reorder Point (units)	Status	Optimized Cost
SKU-013	Lot-for-Lot	357	Place Order	\$949,378
SKU-009	Lot-for-Lot	340	Place Order	\$753,321
SKU-001	EOQ	133	Place Order	\$499,475
SKU-004	EOQ	137	Place Order	\$497,665
SKU-011	EOQ	140	Place Order	\$427,359
SKU-035	Lot-for-Lot	121	Place Order	\$425,383
SKU-003	EOQ	159	Place Order	\$387,896
SKU-025	Lot-for-Lot	99	Place Order	\$386,621
SKU-029	Lot-for-Lot	124	Place Order	\$328,070
SKU005	EOQ	160	Place Order	\$310,274
SKU-007	Lot-for-Lot	93	Place Order	\$305,912
SKU-012	EOQ	138	Place Order	\$288,898
SKU-014	EOQ	140	Place Order	\$271,655
SKU-018	EOQ	79	Place Order	\$215,450
SKU-031	EOQ	76	Place Order	\$202,025
SKU-021	EOQ	62	Place Order	\$184,443
SKU-022	EOQ	62	Place Order	\$177,071
SKU-010	EOQ	140	Place Order	\$174,713
SKU-027	EOQ	48	Place Order	\$172,944
SKU-024	EOQ	48	Place Order	\$143,456
SKU-028	EOQ	80	Place Order	\$140,478
SKU-015	EOQ	158	Place Order	\$132,706

SKU	Order Method	Reorder Point (units)	Status	Optimized Cost
SKU-034	EOQ	48	Place Order	\$131,524
SKU-017	EOQ	52	Place Order	\$128,388
SKU-030	EOQ	60	Place Order	\$112,451

13.2 Category B — Moderate-Priority Items (30 SKUs)

SKU	Order Method	Reorder Point (units)	Status	Optimized Cost
SKU-002	Lot-for-Lot	80	Place Order	\$243,186
SKU-006	Lot-for-Lot	91	Place Order	\$236,161
SKU-075	Lot-for-Lot	17	Place Order	\$231,921
SKU-060	Lot-for-Lot	28	Place Order	\$230,122
SKU-058	Lot-for-Lot	18	Place Order	\$229,331
SKU-039	Lot-for-Lot	28	Place Order	\$228,186
SKU-063	Lot-for-Lot	28	Place Order	\$225,848
SKU-037	Lot-for-Lot	28	Place Order	\$224,688
SKU-026	Lot-for-Lot	28	Place Order	\$224,627
SKU-097	Lot-for-Lot	27	Place Order	\$223,901
SKU-040	Lot-for-Lot	16	Place Order	\$221,076
SKU-070	Lot-for-Lot	20	Place Order	\$220,319
SKU-042	Lot-for-Lot	17	Place Order	\$219,723
SKU-016	Lot-for-Lot	29	Place Order	\$219,279
SKU-033	Lot-for-Lot	25	Place Order	\$218,673
SKU-099	Lot-for-Lot	19	Place Order	\$218,398
SKU-023	Lot-for-Lot	107	Place Order	\$213,429
SKU-059	EOQ	42	Place Order	\$145,683
SKU-019	EOQ	50	Place Order	\$140,456
SKU-045	EOQ	49	Place Order	\$128,210
SKU-048	EOQ	44	Place Order	\$123,943
SKU-091	EOQ	47	Place Order	\$113,736

SKU	Order Method	Reorder Point (units)	Status	Optimized Cost
SKU-065	EOQ	44	Place Order	\$111,396
SKU-100	EOQ	40	Place Order	\$102,417
SKU-062	EOQ	46	Place Order	\$94,353
SKU-071	EOQ	46	Place Order	\$81,946
SKU-055	EOQ	48	Place Order	\$69,064
SKU-008	EOQ	161	Place Order	\$57,283
SKU-069	EOQ	44	Place Order	\$55,711
SKU-079	EOQ	44	Place Order	\$54,512

13.3 Category C — Low-Priority Items (45 SKUs)

SKU	Order Method	Reorder Point (units)	Status	Optimized Cost
SKU-054	Lot-for-Lot	31	Place Order	\$214,575
SKU-093	Lot-for-Lot	18	Place Order	\$214,245
SKU-038	Lot-for-Lot	30	Place Order	\$213,930
SKU-082	Lot-for-Lot	18	Place Order	\$211,720
SKU-044	Lot-for-Lot	29	Place Order	\$211,505
SKU-081	Lot-for-Lot	30	Place Order	\$210,691
SKU-056	Lot-for-Lot	16	Place Order	\$210,528
SKU-057	Lot-for-Lot	16	Place Order	\$210,441
SKU-049	Lot-for-Lot	15	Place Order	\$210,329
SKU-090	Lot-for-Lot	16	Place Order	\$210,254
SKU-094	Lot-for-Lot	18	Place Order	\$210,082
SKU-064	Lot-for-Lot	17	Place Order	\$208,754
SKU-032	Lot-for-Lot	28	Place Order	\$207,354
SKU-089	Lot-for-Lot	17	Place Order	\$206,130
SKU-080	Lot-for-Lot	28	Place Order	\$205,077
SKU-047	Lot-for-Lot	18	Place Order	\$204,716
SKU-095	Lot-for-Lot	18	Place Order	\$204,446

SKU	Order Method	Reorder Point (units)	Status	Optimized Cost
SKU-084	Lot-for-Lot	18	Place Order	\$203,229
SKU-073	Lot-for-Lot	28	Place Order	\$202,789
SKU-077	Lot-for-Lot	5	Place Order	\$201,675
SKU-078	Lot-for-Lot	31	Place Order	\$201,181
SKU-083	Lot-for-Lot	6	Place Order	\$201,131
SKU-092	Lot-for-Lot	5	Place Order	\$201,106
SKU-096	Lot-for-Lot	6	Place Order	\$200,979
SKU-076	Lot-for-Lot	5	Place Order	\$200,563
SKU-020	Lot-for-Lot	28	Place Order	\$200,464
SKU-086	Lot-for-Lot	16	Place Order	\$200,245
SKU-066	Lot-for-Lot	4	Place Order	\$199,772
SKU-088	Lot-for-Lot	17	Place Order	\$199,733
SKU-050	Lot-for-Lot	5	Place Order	\$199,404
SKU-041	Lot-for-Lot	16	Place Order	\$199,344
SKU-087	Lot-for-Lot	18	Place Order	\$198,861
SKU-043	Lot-for-Lot	6	Place Order	\$198,559
SKU-068	Lot-for-Lot	6	Place Order	\$198,317
SKU-061	Lot-for-Lot	15	Place Order	\$198,282
SKU-085	Lot-for-Lot	18	Place Order	\$197,917
SKU-051	Lot-for-Lot	5	Place Order	\$197,715
SKU-067	Lot-for-Lot	4	Place Order	\$197,334
SKU-053	Lot-for-Lot	16	Place Order	\$196,940
SKU-074	Lot-for-Lot	4	Place Order	\$196,880
SKU-098	Lot-for-Lot	5	Place Order	\$196,786
SKU-046	Lot-for-Lot	12	Place Order	\$196,728
SKU-036	Lot-for-Lot	5	Place Order	\$195,996
SKU-072	Lot-for-Lot	3	Place Order	\$195,583
SKU-052	EOQ	46	Place Order	\$20,743

Note: “Order Method” refers to how the order quantity is calculated (EOQ = Economic Order Quantity for steady, higher-volume items; Lot-for-Lot = order to match expected need for lumpier, lower-volume items). Full order quantities, safety stock, and lead-time assumptions per SKU are available in the accompanying Excel workbook.